07-17 第二篇

Learning to Be Grateful

Gratitude is more than saying "thank you"—it is a way of seeing the world that focuses on what we have rather than what we lack. Studies show that people who practice gratitude regularly tend to be happier, healthier, and more satisfied with their lives. They sleep better, have stronger relationships, and cope better with stress. Despite these benefits, many people find it hard to feel grateful when life gets difficult. [1]

[2] One simple practice is to keep a gratitude journal. Each day, write down three things you are thankful for. They can be big or small—a kind word from a friend, a beautiful sunset, or a meal shared with family. Over time, this habit trains the brain to notice positive experiences more often. Many people report feeling more content after just a few weeks.

[3] Gratitude also strengthens our relationships. When we express thanks to others, we acknowledge their effort and kindness. This makes them feel valued and encourages more positive behavior. A simple "thank you" or a note of appreciation can deepen friendships and family bonds. Gratitude, in this way, creates a cycle of warmth and goodwill.

[4] It is important to remember that gratitude does not mean ignoring problems or pretending that everything is fine. We can be grateful for what we have while still working to improve our lives. In tough times, focusing on small blessings—like health, shelter, or support from others—can help us keep going. Gratitude gives us perspective.

[5] Gratitude is a skill we can develop with practice. It does not require special talents or resources—only a willingness to notice and appreciate the good in our lives. The more we practice, the more natural it becomes. A grateful heart can transform how we experience each day.

选项

A. Learning to cultivate gratitude, however, is possible even when times are tough. B. There are many ways to build a gratitude habit. C. Gratitude reaches beyond our personal well-being. D. Gratitude should not be confused with blind positivity. E. The good news is that anyone can learn to be more grateful. F. For example, some people set a daily reminder on their phone to pause and reflect.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- [1] A：
  - **线索**：第一段定义感恩、列举研究中的身心益处，并指出不少人在困难时难以为感恩。空格前形成转折。选项A "Learning to cultivate gratitude, however, is possible even when times are tough" 承接"find it hard"，用"however"转折，引出即便困难时也可培养感恩，承上启下。
- [2] B：
  - **线索**：第二段讲具体方法：感恩日记、每日三件事、可大可小、训练大脑、数周见效。选项B "There are many ways to build a gratitude habit" 概括本段为方法介绍，与后文"One simple practice"及 journal 内容一致。
- [3] C：
  - **线索**：第三段讲感恩对关系的作用：表达感谢让对方感到被重视、促进积极行为、加深感情、形成善意循环。选项C "Gratitude reaches beyond our personal well-being" 从个人福祉过渡到人际层面，与后文"relationships""friendships""family bonds"呼应。
- [4] D：
  - **线索**：第四段澄清感恩不等于忽视问题或盲目乐观，可在感恩的同时努力改善，困难时关注小确幸以保持希望。选项D "Gratitude should not be confused with blind positivity" 点明本段为概念辨析，避免误解。
- [5] E：
  - **线索**：末段总结感恩是可练习的技能、无需特殊条件、练习越多越自然、改变每日体验。选项E "The good news is that anyone can learn to be more grateful" 呼应"skill we can develop"与"anyone"，收束有力。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, some people set a daily reminder on their phone to pause and reflect.**：与感恩练习相关，可作为第二段 journal 之外的又一方法。但第二段空格在段首，需主题句；若插具体"手机提醒"会与"gratitude journal"形成并列，打乱"One simple practice"的单一焦点。属主题相关但论述层次错位型干扰。